
Bluesky's age assurance sucks, here's how to work around it.

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<https://gist.github.com/mary-ext/6e27b24a83838202908808ad528b3318>

Bluesky's age assurance sucks, here's how to work around it.

Bluesky has implemented age verification measures in response to regional laws that restrict access:

- **UK users** are shown a banner for attempting identity verification through [Epic Games' Kids Web Services](#) before they could access adult content, following the [Online Safety Act](#).
- **Mississippi users** are completely blocked from accessing Bluesky due to [HB 1126](#), which would require identity verification for all users regardless of content preferences.
- **South Dakota and Wyoming users** face similar restrictions to UK users due to [HB 1053 and HB 43](#) respectively.
- **Ohio users** face similar restrictions to UK users due to [HB 96](#).

This sucks, but thankfully there are ways to work around it.

This was obvious, but using a VPN to connect from outside your location will bypass the age assurance requirements entirely.

If you don't already have one, a VPN routes your connection through servers in other countries and prevents your ISP from tracking and selling your browsing data, though you're essentially trading trust from your ISP to your VPN provider instead.

My personal recommendations are [Mullvad](#), [IVPN](#) or [ProtonVPN](#).

Don't fall for VPN services that heavily focus on marketing, especially if they market features like "military-grade encryption" or make exaggerated privacy claims.

You don't have to use the official Bluesky app to access the platform. Third-party clients like [Klearsky](#) or [TOKIMEKI](#) currently don't implement these restrictions. For read-only access without signing in, [Anartia](#) is also available.

Note that these alternatives work only as long as their developers don't implement similar age assurance measures or block UK users outright (and as the person behind Anartia, I have no plans to implement such thing.)

You can add the following filter rules to your adblocker.

```
||ip.bsky.app/config$replace=/(?<="countryCode":").+?(?=")/US/  
||ip.bsky.app/config$replace=/(?<="regionCode":").+?(?=")/WA/  
||ip.bsky.app/config$replace=/(?<="isAgeRestrictedGeo":)true/false/  
||ip.bsky.app/config$replace=/(?<="isAgeBlockedGeo":)true/false/
```

1. Open uBlock Origin dashboard › My filters
2. Enable *Enable my custom filters*

-
3. Enable *Allow custom filters requiring trust*
 4. Add the rules provided above

1. Open Settings › Shields › Content filtering
2. Enable *Developer mode*
3. Add the rules provided above to *Create custom filters*

1. Open Ghostery extension window › Ad-Blocking › Custom Filters
2. Make sure it's enabled
3. Add the rules provided above

1. Open Adbguard Settings › User Rules
2. Make sure it's enabled
3. Add the rules provided above

Note: Custom filter rules is a paid feature on the Android version.

Based on testing, this seems to produce wonky results. The setup process is also more complex. But if it works, it allows you to use Bluesky's Android app as usual.

1. Create a text file containing the filter rules provided above and save it to somewhere accessible
2. Open Adbguard and navigate to Settings › Filtering › Filters › Custom Filters › Add custom filter
3. Tap *Browse* and locate the text file you created
4. Select the file to add it as a custom filter list

Chrome's Manifest v3 changes broke all adblockers including uBlock Origin by replacing the `webRequest` API that they rely on with the less powerful `declarativeNetRequest` API instead. uBlock Origin Lite was created specifically to work with DNR, and thankfully it's still very usable for our purposes.

1. Install uBlock Origin Lite
 - [Chrome](#)
 - [Safari](#)
2. Open uBlock Origin Lite dashboard
3. Enable *Developer mode*
4. Head to Develop › View: Custom DNR rules
5. Insert the following rules:

```
---
priority: 1
action:
  type: redirect
  redirect:
    url: https://gist.githubusercontent.com/mary-
ext/6e27b24a83838202908808ad528b3318/raw/ipcc-response.json
condition:
  requestDomains:
    - ip.bsky.app
```

```
initiatorDomains:
  - bsky.app
  - main.bsky.dev
urlFilter: /config
resourceTypes:
  - xmlhttprequest
---
priority: 1
action:
  type: redirect
  redirect:
    url: https://gist.githubusercontent.com/mary-ext/6e27b24a83838202908808ad528b3318/raw/getAgeAssuranceState-response.json
condition:
  initiatorDomains:
    - bsky.app
    - main.bsky.dev
  urlFilter: /xrpc/app.bsky.unspecced.getAgeAssuranceState
  resourceTypes:
    - xmlhttprequest
---
```

You can use userscripts, or scriptlets in Brave.

1. Install a userscript manager

- Chrome: [Violentmonkey](#)
- Firefox: [Violentmonkey](#)
- Edge: [Violentmonkey](#)
- Safari: [Userscripts](#)

2. Install [this userscript](#)

Open Settings › Shields › Content filtering (or go to `about:adblock`)

Enable *Developer mode*, and add the following scriptlet, saving it as `user-bsky-age-assurance.js`.

```
const _fetch = globalThis.fetch;
globalThis.fetch = async function (req, init) {
  if (req instanceof Request) {
    const url = new URL(req.url);
    switch (url.pathname) {
      case '/xrpc/app.bsky.unspecced.getAgeAssuranceState': {
        return Response.json({
          lastInitiatedAt: '2025-07-14T14:22:43.912Z',
          status: 'assured',
        });
      }
    }
  }
  return _fetch(req, init);
};
```

```

    }
  }
  } else if (req === 'https://ip.bsky.app/config') {
    return Response.json({
      countryCode: 'US',
      regionCode: 'WA',
      isAgeBlockedGeo: false,
      isAgeRestrictedGeo: false,
    });
  }
  return _fetch.call(this, req, init);
};

```

Then reference the scriptlet in a custom filter.

```

bsky.app##+js(user-bsky-age-assurance.js)
main.bsky.dev##+js(user-bsky-age-assurance.js)

```

This is applicable to everyone except Mississippi users, as the app would ignore identity verification status.

If your account is hosted on a PDS you own or control, you can add these rules to your Nginx or Caddy configuration.

```

server {
  server_name pds.example.com;
  location /xrpc/app.bsky.unspecced.getAgeAssuranceState {
    default_type application/json;
    add_header access-control-allow-headers "authorization,dpop,atproto-accept-labelers,atproto-proxy" always;
    add_header access-control-allow-origin "*" always;
    return 200 '{"lastInitiatedAt":"2025-07-14T14:22:43.912Z","status":"assured"}';
  }
}

```

```

pds.example.com {
  handle /xrpc/app.bsky.unspecced.getAgeAssuranceState {
    header content-type "application/json"
    header access-control-allow-headers "authorization,dpop,atproto-accept-labelers,atproto-proxy"
    header access-control-allow-origin "*"
    respond `{"lastInitiatedAt":"2025-07-14T14:22:43.912Z","status":"assured"}` 200
  }
}

```

Bluesky's implementation of age-based content restrictions is entirely client-side, this is an intentional design decision. The API (called the "AppView") doesn't impose content restrictions directly and isn't aware of your location as requests are proxied through your account's hosting server (called the "PDS").

bsky.app (or the "client") checks your location by making a request to `https://ip.bsky.app/config`, which returns:

- `countryCode`: your country based on IP address, which is used for regional content moderation.
- `regionCode`: your state/region code (for US users, determines state-specific restrictions)
- `isAgeRestrictedGeo`: whether your location mandates identity verification
- `isAgeBlockedGeo`: whether your location is blocked from accessing Bluesky

When `isAgeRestrictedGeo` is true, it will then make a request to `<pds host>/xrpc/app.bsky.unspecced.getAgeAssuranceState`, which returns:

- `status`: your account's current verification status
- `lastInitiated`: when you last started the identity verification process

These workarounds exploit the client-side nature of these checks.

Worth noting that decentralized social networks aren't above the law. All platforms, including Mastodon and other federated networks, must comply with local regulations like the Online Safety Act, and a fully decentralized network may need individual server operators to handle compliance.

It remains unclear whether regulators would consider Bluesky's client-side implementation sufficient for legal compliance. However, Bluesky Social PBC could reasonably argue the restrictions are effectively enforced for users on their PDS using unmodified clients, and that's as far as they can guarantee in a decentralized network like Bluesky.

I am not a lawyer however.

While these workarounds provide immediate relief, consider taking action to address the root cause:

- **UK users:** Reach out to your Member of Parliament to express concerns about the Act's impact on privacy and digital rights. You can find your MP and their contact details on the [UK Parliament website](#).
- **Mississippi users:** Contact your state legislators about HB 1126's impact on free speech and access to information. You can find your representatives on the [Mississippi Legislature website](#).
- **South Dakota users:** Contact your state legislators about the HB 1053's impact on privacy and digital rights. You can find your representatives on the [South Dakota Legislature website](#).
- **Wyoming users:** Contact your state legislators about the HB 43's impact on privacy and digital rights. You can find your representatives on the [Wyoming Legislature website](#).

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- **Ohio users:** Contact your state legislators about the HB 96's impact on privacy and digital rights. You can find your representatives on the [Ohio Legislature](#) website.

Consider supporting or getting involved with organizations that advocate for digital rights and privacy:

International:

- [Electronic Frontier Foundation \(EFF\)](#) - Defends civil liberties in the digital world
- [Internet Freedom Foundation](#) - Works to ensure that technology respects fundamental rights

UK-specific:

- [Open Rights Group](#) - Campaigns for digital rights and freedoms in the UK
- [Big Brother Watch](#) - Fights for privacy, free speech and civil liberties

US-specific:

- [American Civil Liberties Union \(ACLU\)](#) - Defends constitutional rights including digital privacy
- [Fight for the Future](#) - Campaigns for digital rights and internet freedom

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